



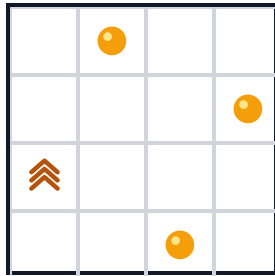
GOBBLE

SIMULTANEOUS-PROGRAMMING SNAKE · 2–6 PLAYERS · ~20 MIN

Everyone programs their moves **in secret**, then all the snakes move **at once**. Eat to grow. The longer your snake, the more points it banks **when it dies** — and dying is how you score. So grow as fat as you dare, cash out at the right moment, and get straight back on the board.

The tension: a short snake is safe and worth almost nothing. A long snake is worth a lot but can barely turn around — and at **maximum length** every scrap of food it eats is worth points right now.

What's in the box



Mini-board — one per player. Food spots and boost spaces are **printed**: they never run out.



Your hand: 6 arrows + your own permanent boost (left, in your colour). Gold boosts are drawn from the deck and discarded after use.

- **6 mini-boards** (4×4). Every board's food layout is different and rotationally asymmetric — turning a board changes the game. Four boards also carry a **boost space**.
- **Arrow cards** — 6 per player, in their colour. Rotate one to aim it.
- **1 personal boost card** per player — always yours, back in hand every round.
- **Boost deck** — generic ×3 boosts you draw from boost spaces and growth milestones.
- **Player board** each — your length track and what each length is worth.
- **Score track** (1–100) and a marker per player.
- **Snake pieces** — 1 head + up to 13 body segments per player, double-sided so they flip to **bounty**.
- **A 15-second timer** — phone or sand.

The pieces at a glance



Food spot
printed · +1 segment



Boost space
printed · draw 1 boost card



Bounty chip
from a death · +2 segments, one-shot



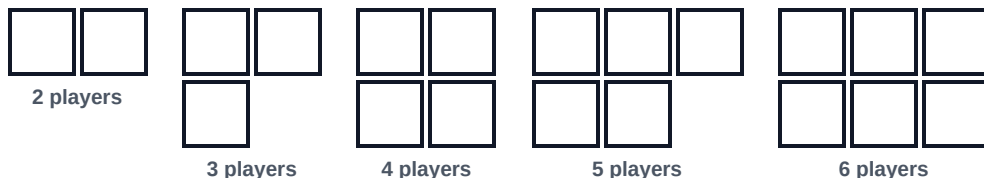
Head
leads the snake · the point shows its facing



Body segment
flips over to bounty when you die

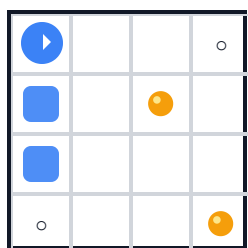
Setup

- 1 **Build the board.** Put out one mini-board per player, packed as close to an even square as possible. Any outside edge — including the notch where a board is missing — is a **wall**.
- 2 **Deal hands.** Each player takes their 6 arrows, their personal boost card, their snake pieces and a player board. Shuffle the gold boost deck into a draw stack. Put every score marker off the track (0 points).
- 3 **Place snakes** at length 3 (see below), in any order you like.

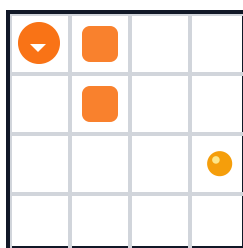


Placing your snake

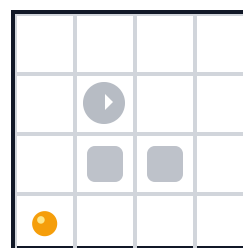
Your snake is **3 segments** on **3 contiguous** cells — straight or bent. At least one of them must **touch a corner of any mini-board** (the ringed cells below). The head goes on one end and simply points away from its neck. You may cover printed food — **you never eat what you cover**.



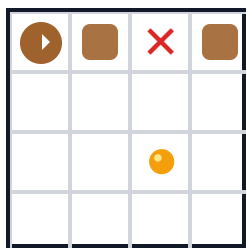
Legal — the tail end sits on a corner cell.



Legal — bends are fine, and the head is on the corner.



Illegal — nothing touches a corner.



Illegal — the three cells are not contiguous.

Respawning works exactly the same way — a snake that died comes back next round at length 3, on any 3 contiguous cells touching a board corner, avoiding snakes and bounty chips.

Playing a round

1 • Program, in secret

Lay **2 to 6 cards** face-down in a row in front of you. The leftmost resolves first. Rotate a card to aim it. If you lay fewer than 6, your snake simply **stops in place** for the rest of the round.



Four programmed moves: up, up, a **boost** (3 cells right, rotated), right — then two rounds of standing still.

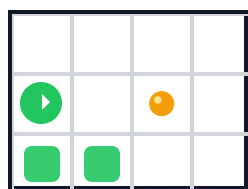
🕒 **The panic timer.** The instant the **first** player finishes their row, start the 15-second timer. When it runs out, everybody else locks **whatever they have** — finished or not. Fast programming is a weapon.

2 • Reveal and resolve, one slot at a time

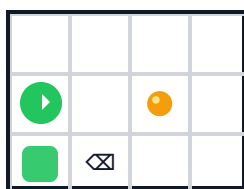
Flip every row face-up. Resolve slot 1 for everyone, then slot 2, and so on. Inside a single slot:

- 1 **Boosts slide first.** Every boosting snake moves its full 3 cells, one cell at a time, together.
- 2 **Then arrows.** Every arrow snake steps 1 cell, all at the same time.

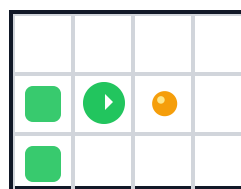
And each individual move happens in this order:



a. Before the move.



b. Tail clears. Lift your last segment — unless this move will grow you.



c. Head slides one cell, and the lifted segment fills the gap behind it.



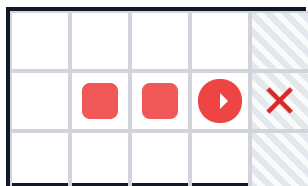
d. Eat. Landing on food adds a segment — the printed spot stays for next time.

3 • End of the round

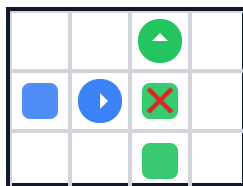
There is **no upkeep** — the food is printed on the boards and never needs replacing. Respawn anyone who died, check whether anybody has hit the target score, and program the next round.

Crashing

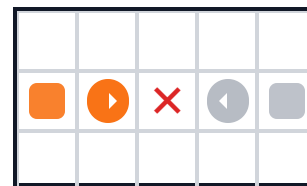
A head that moves into a **wall**, into **any snake's body**, or into a **tail that hasn't cleared** — that snake **dies**. Your own body counts. The red X marks the cell where the crash happens.



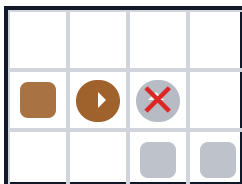
Wall. The board edge — or the hatched gap where no board was placed — kills you.



Body. Blue drives into green's middle. **Only blue dies** — green is untouched.

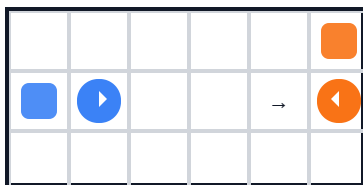


Head-on. Both enter the same cell in the same instant — **both die**.

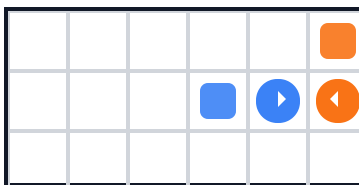


Into a parked head. Silver programmed no move this slot, so **only brown** — the one that moved — dies.

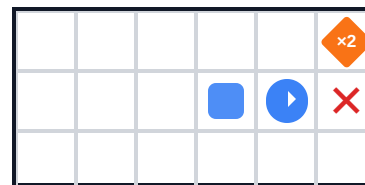
Boosts go first, and that matters. A boosting snake reaches a contested cell before any arrow-mover does. The arrow snake arriving a beat later simply crashes into its side — the booster is safe.



1 • Before. Blue programmed a **boost** (3 cells right); orange a single arrow left. Both want the marked cell.



2 • Boosts resolve first. Blue slides its full 3 cells and now **occupies** the cell.



3 • Then arrows. Orange moves into an occupied cell and **dies** — its head leaves and its segment flips to bounty. **Blue lives**.

A boost is checked cell by cell: if it crashes on the 1st or 2nd cell it dies there and never finishes the slide.

Eating & growing

YOU ENTERED	GROWTH	BOOST CARDS	NOTES
🟡 Food spot	+1 segment	—	Printed — never runs out . A snake sitting on it just blocks it.
🔥 Boost space	—	draw 1	Printed on 4 of the 6 boards — also never runs out.
♦ Bounty chip	+2 segments	—	Dropped by a death. One-shot — remove it once eaten.

New segments appear **behind the head** and unspool as you move. Anything that doesn't grow you resolves like a normal move — your tail piece just fills the gap.

Growth milestones — every time your snake **reaches an even length** (4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14), take an extra boost card from the deck. Those lengths are marked with 🔥 on your player board. You may hold at most **6** drawn boost cards (your personal one is always on top of that).

Your player board

Move a marker along it as you grow. The number under each space is what you **bank if you die at that length**.

123456789101215

🔥🔥🔥🔥🔥🔥

length 3 → 14 · the gold space is maximum length

At maximum length (14) your snake stops growing — and every food you eat instead scores **+2 points immediately** (a ×2 bounty chip scores **+4**). A maxed snake parked on good food spots simply prints points, which is why staying alive up there beats crashing on purpose.

🟢

▶

🟡

🟢

A maxed snake about to eat...

🟢

🟢

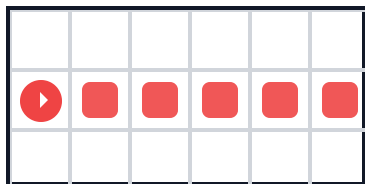
▶

+2

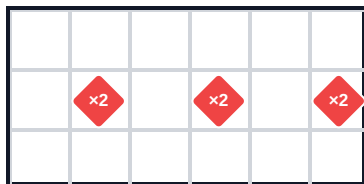
...doesn't grow, and scores +2 on the spot. The food spot is still there for the next pass.

Dying — which is the point

- 1 **Bank your length.** Score the number under your current space on the player board: length 3 = 1 point, all the way up to length 14 = **15 points**.
- 2 **Drop bounty.** Your head leaves the board. Flip **every other body segment** — the first one behind the head, then every second one after it — to its bounty side; remove the segments in between. Each chip is worth **×2 food** to whoever eats it.
- 3 **Respawn** next round at length 3, touching a board corner (see Setup).



A red snake at length 6 — about to crash.



It banks 4 points and leaves **3 bounty chips** — every other segment. The rest go back in the box.

Winning

The moment anybody reaches **70 points**, the game ends immediately — but it isn't over yet:

- **Every snake still alive cashes out**, banking points for its current length off the same ladder.
- Compare totals. **Highest total wins.**

Crossing the line first does **not** guarantee the win — a rival sitting on a huge live snake can leapfrog you on the cash-out.

Ties: whoever ate the most food this game takes it; still tied, share the victory.

Quick reference

- 1 **Program** 2–6 cards face-down. Arrow = 1 cell · Boost = 3 cells. Your own boost comes back every round; drawn ones are discarded.
- 2 The first player to lock starts the **15-second timer**; everyone else locks whatever they have when it ends.
- 3 **Resolve slot by slot:** boosts slide first, then all arrows step together. Tail clears → head slides → check crashes → eat.
- 4 **Food** +1 segment (never runs out) · **boost space** draw 1 · **bounty chip** +2 segments. Even lengths draw a boost card. At **max 14**, every food is worth **2 points**.
- 5 **Crash** = death: bank your length, flip every other segment to bounty, respawn on a corner next round.
- 6 **First to 70** ends it — living snakes cash out, highest total wins.

Three habits of a good Gobble player: program a safe pair of moves before you program a greedy one; watch which rivals still hold boost cards; and never let a fat snake wander somewhere it can't turn around.